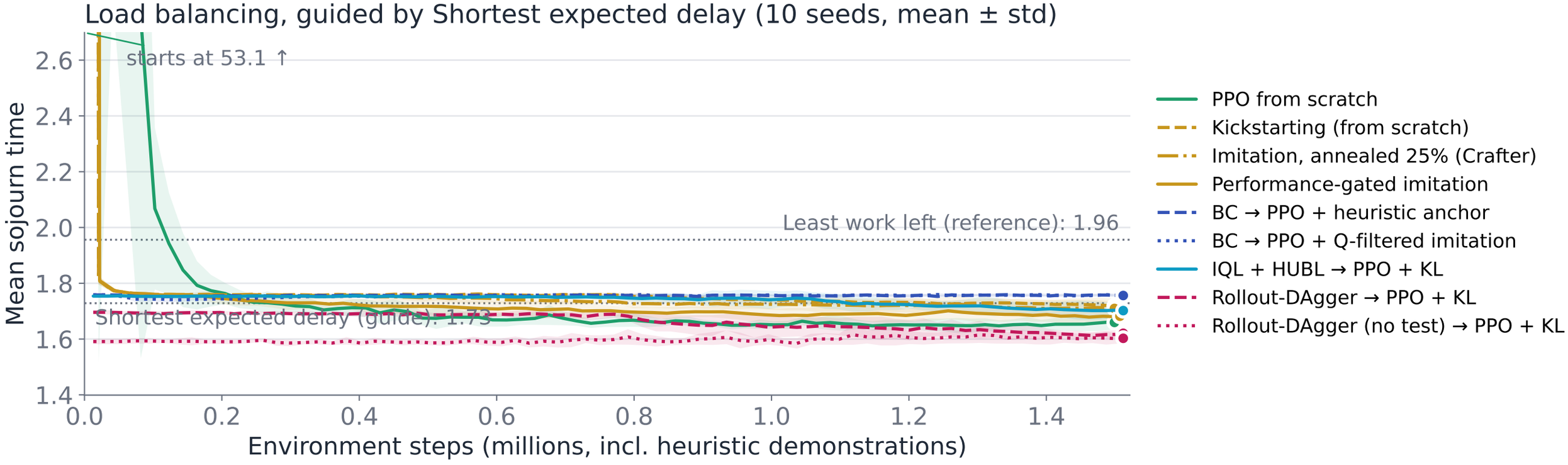
Load balancing, guided by Shortest expected delay (10 seeds, mean ± std)
starts at 53.1 ↑
Least work left (reference): 1.96
Shortest expected delay (guide): 1.73
Mean sojourn time
2.6
2.4
2.2
2.0
1.8
1.6
1.4
0.0
0.2
0.4
0.6
0.8
1.0
1.2
1.4
Environment steps (millions, incl. heuristic demonstrations)
PPO from scratch
Kickstarting (from scratch)
Imitation, annealed 25% (Crafter)
Performance-gated imitation
BC → PPO + heuristic anchor
BC → PPO + Q-filtered imitation
IQL + HUBL → PPO + KL
Rollout-DAgger → PPO + KL
Rollout-DAgger (no test) → PPO + KL